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AI Evals for Designers: Quick Checklist

Five steps to find where your AI product goes wrong, using 20 real answers and a spreadsheet. About two hours, no code.

01 **Collect 20 real answers**

Pull 20 real conversations or outputs from your product. Include the awkward ones: requests it cannot handle, missing information, things it should refuse.

For example: Support bot: Real tickets, including refund requests and an angry customer · Writing assistant: Drafts from very short prompts and off-brand requests · Search or summary: Questions with no good answer in the sources

02 **Mark each one pass or fail**

Ask one question: would I be happy if a real user got this? When it fails, write one plain line on the first thing wrong. No scores and no categories yet.

For example: Support bot: Fail: promises a refund it cannot issue · Writing assistant: Fail: tone far too casual for a legal email · Search or summary: Fail: summary leaves out the main caveat

03 **Group the notes and count**

Sort the notes into piles the way you would affinity-map research. Count each pile. The biggest pile is your first problem.

For example: Support bot: Claims actions it cannot take · Writing assistant: Ignores the requested tone · Search or summary: Drops important caveats

04 **Turn the biggest pile into one rule**

Write it as a yes or no question that anyone on the team could apply to an answer and get the same verdict.

For example: Support bot: Does it only promise actions the product can actually take? · Writing assistant: Does the draft match the tone the user asked for? · Search or summary: Does the summary keep every caveat from the source?

05 **Fix, then re-check the same 20 plus 5 new ones**

Change one thing, rerun the same answers and apply the same rule. Add a few the fix never saw, so you know it works beyond the ones you tuned it on.

For example: Any product: Count how many answers break the rule, before and after · Any product: Read the new ones too: a fix can quietly break something else

#	Input (what the user asked or did)	Output (what the AI said)	Pass / Fail	First thing wrong (one line)	Group
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					

Full method: aiuxdesign.guide/guides/ai-evals-for-designers

Review sheet: aiuxdesign.guide/ai-evals-checklist